

Team AI Readiness Sprint

A structured readiness process for teams that want to identify useful AI opportunities before buying tools or launching policies.

Format	Two or three Zoom sessions with discovery worksheets and a readiness summary.
Level	Level 3: organizational readiness and use-case discovery
Audience	Small and midsize companies, nonprofits, health care teams, and institutions that need cautious, practical alignment.

Learner outcomes

- Map current work patterns, friction points, comfort levels, and risk concerns.
- Rank possible AI use cases by value, risk, readiness, and training needs.
- Clarify what to train, what to pilot, what to postpone, and what not to do.
- Create a practical readiness map before buying tools or announcing large AI initiatives.

Guiding questions

- Where are people already experimenting, and where are they hesitant?
- Which tasks create friction, delay, rework, or knowledge bottlenecks?
- Which ideas are low-risk training candidates, and which need stronger review before action?
- What should we learn before spending money on tools or vendors?

Readiness checks

- The team can distinguish training needs from implementation or procurement needs.
- Use cases are ranked by value, risk, readiness, and review burden.
- Sensitive-data concerns are named without implying legal or compliance guarantees.
- Next steps are limited enough to learn from safely.

Curriculum modules

Team context scan

We identify where AI curiosity already exists, where anxiety is highest, and where work is repetitive or overloaded.

Use-case discovery

Participants collect possible use cases and sort them by task type, data sensitivity, and expected value.

Risk and readiness scoring

We use a simple matrix to distinguish low-risk practice from decisions that need stronger review or policy.

Training path recommendation

The sprint ends with a practical next-step map for briefings, workshops, office hours, or a limited pilot.

Governance questions for later

The sprint names policy, procurement, privacy, and implementation questions that should be handled by the right internal owners.

Session flow

Discover

Interview or workshop with leaders and users to surface real work patterns, pain points, and comfort levels.

Inventory

Collect possible use cases and describe each one by task type, data sensitivity, value, and review needs.

Score

Rank ideas with a simple value, risk, readiness, and training-needs rubric.

Sort

Place ideas into train, pilot, wait, or avoid categories.

Recommend

Translate findings into a short next-step roadmap for training, office hours, or a narrow pilot.

Practice labs

Friction mapping

Identify where teams lose time to drafting, summarizing, searching, rework, planning, or coordination.

Use-case card sorting

Turn vague AI ideas into comparable cards with audience, input, output, review, and risk fields.

Value-risk matrix

Place candidate use cases on the grid and discuss what belongs in training, pilot, wait, or avoid.

Readiness narrative

Draft a plain-language summary leaders can use to explain the next step without overpromising.

Tangible cases

Nonprofit intake backlog

Situation: A nonprofit team spends too much time sorting public inquiries, drafting first responses, and preparing internal handoffs.

Learner task: Map the workflow, identify safe practice points, and decide which steps are training candidates rather than automation projects.

Starter prompt: Analyze this fictional nonprofit intake workflow. Identify friction points, possible AI training opportunities, data sensitivity concerns, review needs, and whether each idea belongs in train, pilot, wait, or avoid: [fictional workflow].

Clinic admin documentation

Situation: A health care organization wants to improve admin templates but is cautious about patient privacy and medical claims.

Learner task: Separate generic documentation practice from anything requiring internal privacy, clinical, legal, or compliance owners.

Starter prompt: Given this fictional clinic admin workflow, list low-risk AI training ideas, items that require private systems or internal approval, and items to avoid. Do not provide medical, legal, compliance, or cybersecurity assurances: [fictional workflow].

Customer support knowledge gaps

Situation: A small company has scattered public FAQ pages and repeated support questions.

Learner task: Score possible use cases by value, risk, readiness, and review burden before any tool purchase.

Starter prompt: Turn these fictional support pain points into use-case cards. For each card, include task, user, input, output, value, risk, readiness, review owner, and recommended next step: [pain points].

Prompt library

Friction map

Help a team map workflow friction. Ask for recurring tasks, delays, rework, handoffs, knowledge bottlenecks, and sensitive-data concerns. Then summarize likely AI training opportunities.

Use-case card

Create a use-case card for this AI idea with user, task, input, output, value, risk, data sensitivity, review owner, readiness, and training need: [idea].

Value-risk scoring

Score these AI ideas from 1 to 5 for value, risk, readiness, and review burden. Explain each score and sort the ideas into train, pilot, wait, or avoid: [ideas].

Readiness summary

Draft a cautious readiness summary for leaders. Include what the team is ready to learn, what should be postponed, what needs specialist review, and the smallest practical next step: [findings].

Materials to develop

- Team readiness worksheet
- Use-case scoring rubric
- AI norms discussion guide
- Recommended next-step summary template
- Use-case card deck
- Train, pilot, wait, avoid decision sheet

Diagram candidates

These are intentionally left as candidate visuals until diagram parameters are chosen.

- Use-case value/risk grid
- Team adoption pathway from discovery to practice
- Readiness map from friction points to training path

Follow-up work

- Choose two low-risk training candidates and one idea to postpone.
- Schedule the right briefing or workshop for the highest-priority audience.
- Review the map monthly as team fluency and tool options change.

Session design reminders

- Keep examples non-sensitive and realistic.
- Emphasize education, judgment, review, and careful experimentation.
- Do not promise legal, medical, compliance, cybersecurity, or automation outcomes.
- Name when a stronger tool, private environment, or policy decision is needed before proceeding.

API and tool boundary

This curriculum companion does not require an API call. Any secure password protection, private client portal, or live AI workflow exercise that transmits data to an external model should be reviewed before implementation.